



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 03- Rhetoric in Public Speaking

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES





**“Rhetoric may be defined as the faculty of observing in any given case the available means of persuasion”.
Aristotle in *Rhetoric*
(trans. by W. Rhys Roberts)**

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Aristotelian Modes of Persuasion

❑ Ethos, Pathos and Logos

- ❖ That future is not one of ease or resting but of incessant striving so that we may fulfill the pledges we have so often taken and the one we shall take today. The service of India means, the service of the millions who suffer.
- ❖ “For the price of a cup of coffee, you can feed a starving child.”
- ❖ This is no time for petty and destructive criticism, no time for ill will or blaming others. We have to build the noble mansion of free India where all her children may dwell.

The essence of sophistry consists in the moral purpose, the deliberate use of fallacious arguments. In Dialectic, the dialectician has the power or faculty of making use of them when he pleases; when he does so deliberately, he is called a sophist. In Rhetoric, this distinction does not exist; he who uses sound arguments as well as he who uses false ones are both known as rhetoricians

Historical Background

- The eminent Roman orators, Cicero (106-43 BCE) and Quintilian (35-95 CE), added significantly to the study of rhetoric.
- **Cicero** tried to resolve the perpetual debate regarding content versus delivery in oration. He argued for a balance between the style and the substance - harmony of the rhetorical perspective and the oratorical perspective. He propounded the five canons of Rhetoric for curating a persuasive speech: **Invention, Disposition, Style, Memorization, and Delivery.**
- **Quintilian**, another significant rhetorician believed that knowledge could be acquired through proper education.

- In American Revolution, the rhetorical studies of ancient Greece and Rome were resurrected as speakers and teachers looked to Cicero and others to inspire defense of the new republic.
- John Quincy Adams of Harvard advocated for the democratic advancement of the art of rhetoric.
- Throughout the 20th century, rhetoric developed as a concentrated field of study with the establishment of public speaking courses in high schools and universities. The courses in speaking apply fundamental Greek theories (such as the modes of persuasion: ethos, pathos, and logos).

Rhetoric: Later Trends

- Francis Bacon aimed to bring the power of language under rational control when he said, “. . . the duty of rhetoric is to apply Reason to Imagination for the better moving of the will.”

- Later trends in literature are:
 - Epistemological
 - Belletristic
 - Elocutionist

Contd...

- **The Epistemological Tradition** comprised Campbell's *The Philosophy of Rhetoric* (1776) and Richard Whately's *Elements of Rhetoric* (1828) where they brought forth their knowledge of classical rhetoric and contemporary psychology to create rhetoric based on an understanding of human nature. They inaugurated **audience- centered** approaches to rhetoric and initiated the way for contemporary investigations with audience analysis.

- **The Belles Lettres Movement**, marked a departure from the rationalists and elocutionists, valued **aesthetic qualities** of writing over informative value.
- **The Elocutionary Movement** focused primarily on delivery and was widely publicized as planned gestures, loud and dramatic movements. These trends faded with time.
- ❑ In early twentieth century, however, **National Communication Association** that was formed in the United States by a small group of public speaking teachers who wanted to restore the rich qualities and scope that were once attributed to rhetoric.

TYPES OF PERSUASIVE SPEECHES

Judicial Rhetoric

- Establishes facts and judgments about the past
- Example- detectives at a crime scene

Demonstrative Rhetoric

- Makes a proclamation about the present situation
- Example- wedding speeches

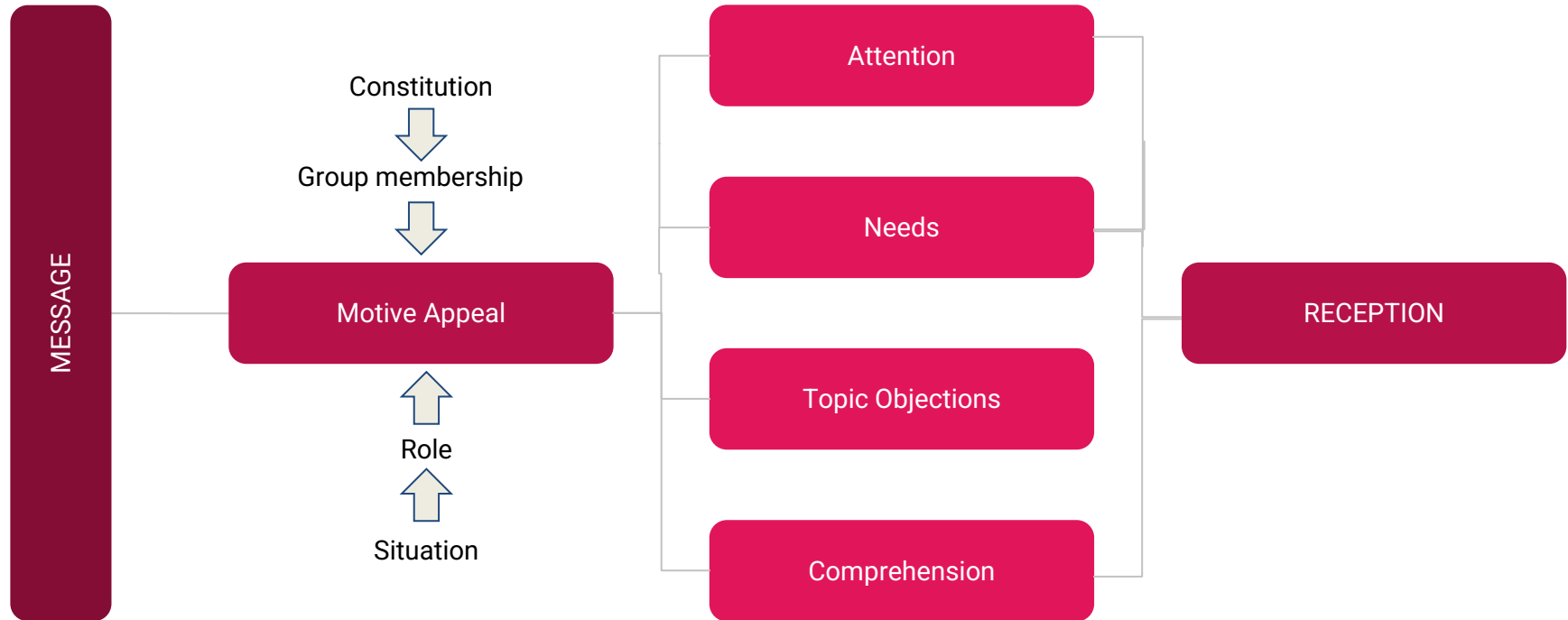
Deliberative Rhetoric

- Focuses on the future
- Employed by Politicians, Activists

Psychology of Persuasion

- A public speaker's personality is entitled with the goal to persuade and determine audience's mood and motivation.
- Kluckhohn and Murray have pointed out four personality determinants for persuader as follows:
 - ❖ Constitution (outward appearance)
 - ❖ Group membership (adaptability)
 - ❖ Role
 - ❖ Situation

Persuasion Filters and Barriers Chart (Ross 1977)



Theories of Persuasion

- ❑ Raymond Ross in his text on *Speech Communication* affirms that rhetoric is “the method of giving effect to the truth” which can also “be taught”.
- ❑ According to **classical rhetoric theory**, there are **five basic tasks** in preparing and sending persuasive messages, which are referred to as “canons”:
 - ❖ Invention: Content of message and audience’s needs
 - ❖ Arrangement: of the whole speech and crux message
 - ❖ Style: of language with regards to the audience
 - ❖ Memory: of speech content in sequential order
 - ❖ Delivery: of message through voice and body action

Theories of Persuasion

Congruity theory of persuasion:

- This theory positions persuasion as a means to seek common agreement and harmony.
- Given the established differences between individuals, a public speaker could act as a mediator to bring people together in congruity.

Balance theory:

- As the name suggests, the theory suggests persuasion as a tool to reduce tension due to imbalance of ideas, motivation and action through speech.
- It is achieved by “modifying either the affective (feelings) or cognitive (belief) element of an attitude.” (Ross 274)

Rhetorical Devices

- A rhetorical device is a technique that is used by a speaker or an author for conveying a particular message to the audience in such a way that it provokes an emotional response to a particular action.
- It is a linguistic tool, whose employment can be used to construct an argument or make an existing one more compelling.

Types of Rhetorical Devices

Alliteration(L) This device is the repetition of sounds of two or more words placed nearby in any sentence. This is usually applied to consonants, employed to emphasize and draw attention.

For example, Five miles meandering with a mazy motion.
(Coleridge).

And the **b**alls like pulses **b**eat;/For the **s**ky and the **s**ea, and the **s**ea
and the **s**ky/Lay like a load on my weary eye. (Coleridge, *Rime of the Ancient Mariner*)

If two witches
were watching
two watches,
which witch
would watch
which watch?

Contd...

Anadiplosis (Gk ‘doubling’) In this rhetorical device, there is a repetition of the last word in a phrase at the beginning of the next phrase or sentence.

For example, Fear leads to anger, anger leads to hate and hate leads to suffering. –Yoda, Star Wars

Labour and care are rewarded with success, success produces confidence, confidence relaxes the industry, and negligence ruins the reputation. (Dr Johnson’s Rambler no. 21)

Antistrophe-(Gk ‘ counter turning’) While using this device, there is a specific type of repetition of words at the end of consecutive phrases/clauses/sentences.

“What lies behind us and what lies before us are tiny compared to what lies within us.” Ralph Waldo Emerson

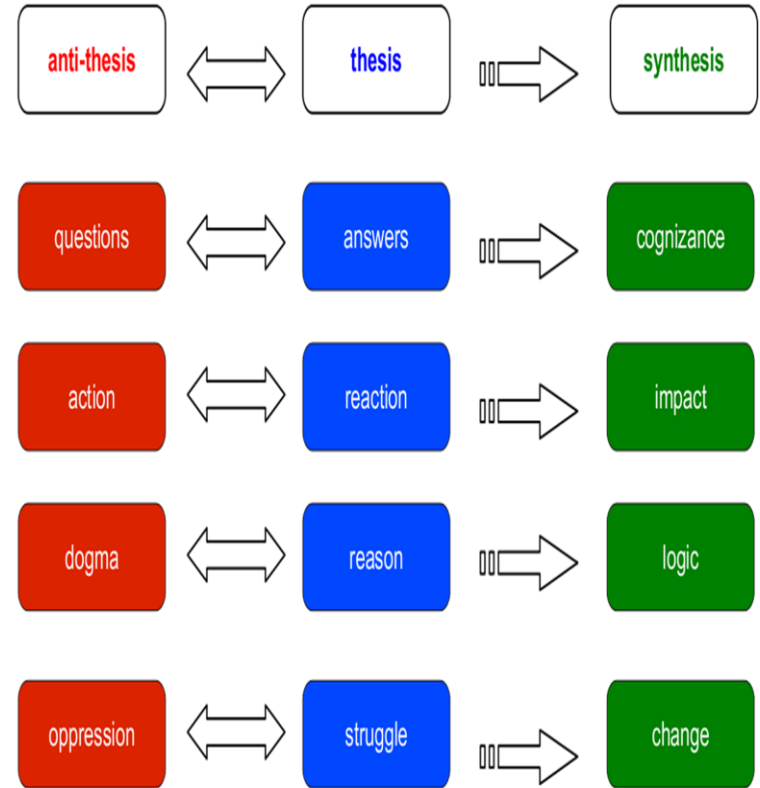
“Selfishness is not living as one wishes to live. It is asking others to live as one wishes to live...” (Wilde)

Antithesis-(Gk.) There are two juxtaposed ideas in one sentence which are opposite and contrasting.

For example, “Ask not what your country can do for you; ask what you can do for your country.”

“Crafty men condemn studies; simple men admire them; and wise men use them.”
(Bacon)

Also, this term is closely associated with thesis and synthesis.



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Anaphora (Gk ‘carrying up or back’)- a rhetorical device involving the repetition of a word or group of words in successive clauses.

And so if we praise him, our words seem rather small, and if we praise him, to some extent we also praise ourselves. (J.L. Nehru)

Diacoep (Gk.) - a repeated word or phrase split up by another word, to display strong emotion.

For example, Free at last! Free at last! Thank god we are free at last! (Martin Luther King)

"Happy families are all alike; every unhappy family is unhappy in its own way. (Leo Tolstoy)

Ellipsis- This particular device has a few words, depicting an event that is omitted to highlight the narrative gaps for readers.

For instance, “Fourscore and seven years ago our fathers brought forth...the proposition that all men are created equal.” (Abraham Lincoln’s Gettysburg Address)

Litotes (Gk litos) This is a commonly used device in conversations where double negatives that present a positive statement. An understatement for emphasis,

For example, ‘She is not thin’, ‘You are not unfamiliar with speech’.

“He hath not failed to pester us with message” - Hamlet (Act 1 Scene 2)

Hyperbole (Gk overcasting) A commonly used expression of mere exaggeration, this device is often used to draw attention to the gravity of the matter or to make a strong point.

For instance, ‘ I have not seen him for ages.’

“I’ll love you till the ocean/ is folded and hung up to dry” - W.H. Auden in his poem “As I Walked Out One Evening.”

The Power of Rhetoric

“I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal.

I have a dream that one day on the red hills of Georgia, the sons of former slaves and the sons of former slave owners will be able to sit down together at the table of brotherhood. **I have a dream** that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin but by the content of their character. **I have a dream today.”** (Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.)

"THE RHETORIC IS THE KEY TO THE CHARACTER.
IT'S THE VERBAL MUSIC OF THE PIECE."

-PETER SHAFFER

Thank You

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